THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 9 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 2: **The Price Puzzle (Economics)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Assertion (A): Government provides public goods. Reason (R): Private firms find it hard to charge users and earn profit. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

2. Assertion (A): Monopoly can be harmful for consumers. Reason (R): A monopolist may raise price and restrict supply. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

3. A good for which price rises while quantity supplied rises shows 1

(a) a movement along the supply curve **(b)** equilibrium
(c) a price ceiling **(d)** a fall in demand

4. Which of the following is NOT a role of government in markets? 1

(a) Protecting consumers **(b)** Providing public goods
(c) Fixing every price permanently **(d)** Checking monopoly

5. Assertion (A): A price ceiling set below equilibrium creates excess demand. Reason (R): At the lower price buyers want more and sellers offer less. 1

(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

6. Which regulator protects consumer rights and checks unfair trade practices? 1

(a) SEBI **(b)** CCPA **(c)** TRAI **(d)** RBI

7. If 30 buyers each demand 2 kg at Rs 50, market demand at Rs 50 is 1

(a) 60 kg **(b)** 32 kg **(c)** 15 kg **(d)** 30 kg

8. If 4 sellers each supply 5 kg at Rs 100 and 2 sellers 10 kg each, market supply is 1

(a) 30 kg **(b)** 40 kg **(c)** 20 kg **(d)** 50 kg

9. **Assertion (A):** The demand curve usually slopes downward. 1
Reason (R): When the price of a good rises, buyers always want to buy more of it.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** A minimum price fixed below the equilibrium price makes a difference to the market. 1
Reason (R): In such a case the market price is already higher than the minimum price.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. At Rs 100 Qd 12, Qs 12. Sketch what happens if demand rises by 6 kg at every price. 2

12. How can a government prevent hoarding? 2

13. Why is the right to regulate not the same as the right to control all prices? 2

14. Explain why a price ceiling must be below equilibrium to be effective. 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Argue why price controls should be temporary. 3

16. Explain why a market may fail to supply sanitation and street lighting. 3

17. Evaluate the need for regulators like SEBI and TRAI. 3

OR

A coffee shop notices fewer customers when tea prices fall. Explain using substitute goods. 3

18. Describe how both demand and supply forces explain the price of masks from 2020 to 2022. 3

OR

Explain how a sudden fall in supply leads to a new equilibrium. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** In 2020 the demand for hand sanitisers rose sharply while supply could not keep pace, and prices shot up. Some traders stored large stocks to sell later at higher prices. The government declared sanitisers essential commodities under the Essential Commodities Act, 1955, and fixed a maximum price. 5
(i) What is a maximum price fixed by the government called?
(ii) Name the Act under which the cap was fixed.
(iii) What is hoarding?
(iv) If the maximum price is set below the equilibrium price, state its likely effect on the market and one problem it can create.

20. Critically examine the role of the government as regulator and provider in India's market. 5

OR

Evaluate the statement that markets always reach and stay at equilibrium. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 40 Marks